EYE TO OBSERVE WHAT THE AVERAGE GERMAN WILL OVERLOOK. … THE CENTER AND BASE OF THIS WORK WILL BE BERLIN, THE UNIFIED BERLIN.[14]

He proposed several titles for the book—"The Children of Reich" and "Die Neuen Deutschen" (The New Germans)—and worked with designers to conceptualize the book's contours and look over the course of a decade. Despite Freed's success as a renowned photographer, concurrently recognized with the planning of a major museum and book retrospective and regularly publishing with German magazines such as *Der Spiegel* and *Stern*, no publisher wanted to take on his post-Wall project. Freed was told it was too soon to look back across the newest dividing line of German history.

In 2005, Freed exhibited some of the prints of this unfinished book project at the Haus der Geschichte in Bonn, under the title *Ein Amerikaner in Deutschland*. Though his image of the trio of American GIs in a phalanx taken in August 1961 became the publicity image for the poster, other images addressed the layering of Freed's view of his career with the evolution of German history alongside American resonances. The exhibition's images complemented his broader cross-cultural connections made in landscapes of national history and memory. Indicative of such a posture is a vision of a reunified Berlin shot in 1990, also featured in this 2005 exhibition, featuring a statue of Otto Von Bismarck (fig. 5.2). Freed printed the photograph in a large, poster size for all the details to emerge. Here, a torso statue of the nineteenth-century unifier of Germany is sphinxed and delimbed, perched on a zigzagging steel beam, held directly above a bicycle and encircled by trolley tracks. Again, Freed approaches his subject at a middle distance. As a whole, the composition appears cubist, and the playful nature of the image contrasts with the serious historical moment. So much is up in the air, and public expressivity is having an impact on the moment, not just for Freed but for the people convening for Berlin's next chapter. Freed had imaged a bicycle in other post–*Wende* images as an emblem of progress, including one in a stationary position in the former death strip, not in the imagery of the American open road but in the potential for a shared fate of transformation and to convey momentary stillness amid enormous social upheaval. In that image, the absence of guards and the presence of the bicycle tell us that while the Wall's architecture remains for the time being, its very fact of openness means it has been neutralized. But in the Bismarck image, one can look past the foreground, as the steel beams construct a window to draw focus toward the signage of an infamous site of